

ALICIA NICOLAS PEDRO

QA Lead | Test Manager | QA Strategy & Governance

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Professional Summary

QA Manager with more than 20 years of experience in software quality assurance across the banking, fintech, retail, and government sectors. Specialist in QA Strategy, Test Management, QA Governance, test automation, CI/CD integration, and Agile/Scrum methodologies. Proven track record leading multidisciplinary teams of up to 19 people -including coordination of remote teams in Colombia- on critical projects for organizations such as HSBC, Scotiabank, BBVA, Santander, Consubanco, Banco Base, MFM CapitalTech, IBM, SAT, and Grupo Bimbo. In her most recent role, achieved a 98% reduction in production incidents and a 100% increase in functional test coverage through a preventive QA strategy and automation integration into CI/CD pipelines.

Core Competencies

- QA Leadership & Strategy: QA Strategy & Governance, Test Management, Stakeholder Management, Risk & Release Management, Quality Process Improvement
- Testing: Functional, Regression, Integration, UAT/OAT, API Testing, Performance, Volume and Stress Testing
- Automation & DevOps: Test Automation Strategy, Selenium WebDriver, CI/CD Integration
- Quality Engineering: Defect Lifecycle Management, QA Metrics & Reporting, Continuous Improvement
- Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Waterfall, CMMI, TMMI, BPM, RBPM, RUP
- Tools: Jira, HP Quality Center / ALM, TFS, Bugzilla, IBM ClearQuest, Selenium WebDriver, Postman, JMeter, LoadRunner
- Databases: SQL Server, Oracle, PostgreSQL, MySQL, DB2
- Languages: Native Spanish, Technical English (reading, documentation, and professional communication)

Keywords

QA Manager, Test Manager, Test Lead, QA Lead, Quality Assurance, Test Management, Test Strategy, Test Planning, Functional Testing, Regression Testing, Integration Testing, UAT, API Testing, Performance Testing, Test Automation, Selenium WebDriver, CI/CD, Agile, Scrum, Waterfall, CMMI, Defect Management, Jira, HP Quality Center, ALM, TFS, Bugzilla, SQL Server, Oracle, Risk Management, Stakeholder Management, Team Leadership, Banking, Fintech, Retail, Government.

Professional Experience

QA Manager | Pacto Technology Mexico

November 2024 - April 2026

- Reduced production incidents by 98% through a preventive QA strategy and improved validation processes.
- Increased functional coverage by 100% across critical business flows, improving release stability.
- Implemented test automation integrated into CI/CD pipelines, defining the QA strategy for web, Android, and POS applications (SmartPos Restaurante project, migrated to BBVA).
- Led the UAT testing phase for AI-powered document digitization in SME credit processes (clients Santander and Scotiabank), and implemented QA metrics dashboards for executive decision-making.
- Led multidisciplinary teams under Agile/Scrum, aligning QA with business objectives.

QA Lead / Test Lead | Publicis Groupe / Digitas

March 2023 - November 2024

- Coordinated the test phase for all web and mobile applications (iOS and Android) developed for client PepsiCo, focused on digital marketing and promotional campaigns.
- Designed testing for fraud identification through analysis of participation tickets and detection of multi-account users.

- Tested an AI-powered CRM integrated into the application, and coordinated integration testing with external vendors prior to production release.

QA Coordinator / Test Manager | Ondore, S.A. de C.V.

August 2013 - March 2023

- Coordinated the test phase for web and mobile applications for banking clients (Bankaool, BancoBase, Consubanco) under Scrum methodology: online banking, investments, and SME credit applications.
- Led quality assurance for a blockchain trading platform (BTC, ETH), including order settlement engine, fiat/digital wallets, and identity management.
- Developed automated regression scripts in Selenium and managed the defect lifecycle in Bugzilla, generating executive reports.
- Developed automation scripts for a mobile application in Cucumber and integrated them with AWS for a test proposal presented to the CEO.

Test Lead / Test Manager | Randstad, Livingston, Stefanini/IBM, Asteci/Scotiabank, HDS, Praxis/HSBC, Deloitte, Hidelbrando/IBM, EDS-HP

2007 - 2013

- Led QA teams of up to 19 people in Mexico and coordinated remote teams in Colombia, on simultaneous projects for SAT, Grupo Bimbo, HSBC Panama, Ford, PepsiCo, Cinopolis, and Afore Banamex.
- Designed test strategies and plans for critical banking and financial systems under RBPM methodology, including Mainframe/CICS testing for HSBC Panama, the KRONER (calculator) project at HSBC, and Digital Fiscal Stamp account statements for Scotiabank.
- Defined quality KPIs and executive reporting for stakeholders; implemented QA process improvements between Mexico and Colombia operations.
- Tools: HP Quality Center / Mercury Quality Center, LoadRunner, TFS, ALM, Clarity.

QA Analyst / Junior Test Engineer / SQA | Softtek (Liverpool, UDLA), Getronics (SAT, CONAGUA, Nextel, Novartis)

2003 - 2007

- Designed and executed functional and regression testing for enterprise systems, including CONAGUA's Comprehensive Water Management System and Nextel and Novartis projects.
- Participated in the initial implementation of test automation and collaborated with development and business teams on requirements gathering.

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science - Instituto Politecnico Nacional (IPN), UPIICSA - 2000 - 2004

Courses

ISTQB Introduction, ISTQB Test Management, PMP, Scrum